



High hopes

ISRO plans on 30 launches in the next three years. Read more about its reusable launch vehicle here: <http://dgit.in/30launchesisro>



Facebook goes feminist

After the logo, Facebook redesigns its icons to be with the times. Read more: <http://dgit.in/fbnewupdt>



Rdio

The biggest problem with Rdio is with its Android app. For one, the app seems designed for the more powerful phones, overlooking phones with weaker SoCs. Although the company says it is working on this aspect, for now, Rdio's app has issues. The app tends to crash often, but the bigger problem is some of Rdio's enforced restrictions that you can do nothing about. While it allows streaming at upto 320 kbps over both mobile data and WiFi, Rdio stops playing at the first sign of signal troubles. In addition, if you've run over your FUP and your WiFi is slow, Rdio will also have trouble downloading tracks, sometimes just skipping the process of its own accord. Rdio even has skips from time to time, especially when you lock your phone.

The good thing about the Rdio app is that it's simple. It doesn't try to do too much, focussing on what is important, that is, a good looking app that is simple to navigate. It also allows gapless playback, where it caches the next song while the first one finishes.

With a price tag of ₹120 per month for Rdio Unlimited, which allows unlimited streaming and downloads, it's competi-

tive. In addition, Rdio also has Rdio Select, which costs ₹60 and allows unlimited ad-free streaming on mobile and 25 downloads, which can be refreshed every day. In its free subscription, Rdio plays ads after every track.

Gaana

The Indian music streaming service Gaana has possibly been spending the most money amongst all of these on marketing itself. The name Gaana is very well known amongst Indian music listeners, and with the backing from Times Music, the service has come out all guns blazing. Gaana has a modern and very good looking UI, with almost all the sections of the app being accessible right on the home screen. In addition, the 'Now Playing' bar is almost exactly the same as Rdio, and looks very good. In addition, while Gaana also has a social connect with Facebook, it doesn't seem to use this for curation.

Incidentally, curation and a western library are where Gaana fails. While its Indian library is simply amazing, with not many songs missing, its western library seems limited to popular or classic tracks.

Gaana can also be subscribed to at ₹99 per month through operator payments which makes it cheaper than both Rdio and Apple Music.



Gaana

Saavn

Gaana's chief competitor in India is Saavn, which, like its compatriot, gets the app right. Saavn is a good looking app like Gaana, but it has two main pitfalls. One, the quality of curation in Saavn is not great, compared to any other app on the list. In addition, the highest quality that the service gives you is of 128 kbps, which is nothing compared to the 320/256 kbps limits that Gaana, Rdio and Apple Music have. Saavn is also more expensive, costing ₹220 per month for 5 devices and unlimited downloads and ₹110 per month for a single device, with download limits of 3 GB. For us, the real deal breaker here is that Saavn puts a download limit even after charging for a Pro subscription that is almost as much as its competitors.

Saavn's western library though seems to be a tad better than what Gaana presents, but it's not big enough to really make a difference. Both Gaana and Saavn seem to be tailored to Indian music.



Saavn

Guvera Music

When you first open the Android app for Guvera Music, you may very well be put off by the number of ads that it has. If you keep to it though, it really is quite good. The app seems to be telling users not to subscribe to it, but listen for free with ads playing in between. Why do we say so? Well, for one, subscription to Guvera is

Name	Cost	Availability	Max. Music Quality
Apple Music	₹120/month individual subscription, ₹190/month family plan with 6 accounts.	iOS and Desktop	256 kbps
Rdio	₹119/month individual subscription, ₹178/month family plan with 4 accounts, ₹60/month Rdio Select	Android, iOS, Windows Phone and Desktop	320 kbps
Gaana	₹123.99/month, operator and PayTM Wallet plans also available	Android, iOS, Windows Phone and Desktop	320/256 kbps
Saavn	₹110/month for 1 device with 3GB downloads, ₹220/month for 5 devices with unlimited downloads	Android, iOS and Desktop	128 kbps
Guvera Music	₹199/month unlimited downloads and streaming	Android, iOS and Desktop	64 kbps
Wynk	₹99/month for non-Airtel users, ₹29/month for Airtel users.	Android and iOS	320/256 kbps
Hungama	Rs. 110/month for unlimited downloads, operator and a-la-carte plans also available	Android, iOS and Desktop	320/256 kbps